



CSS CHEATSHEET FOR BEGINNERS QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE

MEHMOOD KHALIL

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1. INTRODUCTION TO CSS

CSS (Cascading Style Sheets) is used to style and layout HTML elements. You can apply styles in three ways:

01

<!-- Inline -->

```
<h1 style="color: red;">Hello</h1>
```

02

<!-- Internal -->

```
<style>
```

```
  h1 { color: red; }
```

```
</style>
```

03

<!-- External -->

```
<link rel="stylesheet"
```

```
href="style.css">
```

2. SELECTORS & COMBINATORS

Selector / Combinator	Syntax Example	Meaning / Selects
Universal Selector	*	All elements
Type Selector	p	All <p> elements
Class Selector	.box	Elements with class box
ID Selector	#header	Element with ID header
Attribute Selector	input[type="text"]	<input> elements of type text
Group Selector	h1, h2, h3	All <h1>, <h2>, and <h3> elements
Descendant Combinator	div p	All <p> inside a <div> (any depth)
Child Combinator	div > p	All <p> directly inside a <div>
Adjacent Sibling	div + p	<p> immediately after a <div>
General Sibling	div ~ p	All <p> siblings after a <div>
Pseudo-class	a:hover	<a> elements when hovered
Pseudo-element	p::first-line	First line of all <p> elements

3. BOX MODEL

Every HTML element is a box made up of:

- **Content** – the actual text or element.
- **Padding** – space inside the border.
- **Border** – the edge of the element.
- **Margin** – space outside the element.

```
.box {  
  padding: 10px;  
  border: 2px solid black;  
  margin: 20px;  
}
```



4. POSITIONING



`position: static;` Default

`position: relative;` Offset from normal position

`position: absolute;` Positioned relative to nearest ancestor

`position: fixed;` Fixed to the viewport

`position: sticky;` Toggles between relative & fixed

Useful Positions
top, right, bottom, left
z-index

5. FLEXBOX

display: flex;
flex-direction: row | column;
justify-content: center | space-between | space-around;
align-items: center | flex-start | flex-end;
gap: 10px;

```
.container {  
  display: flex;  
  justify-content: center;  
  align-items: center;  
}
```

6. GRID LAYOUT

```
display: grid;  
grid-template-columns: repeat(3, 1fr);  
grid-template-rows: auto;  
gap: 20px;
```

Other Properties

```
justify-items: center;  
align-items: start;  
grid-column: 1 / span 2;  
grid-row: 1 / 3;
```


7. TYPOGRAPHY

font-family: 'Arial', sans-serif;
font-size: 16px;
font-weight: normal | bold | 100–900;
text-align: left | center | right;
line-height: 1.5;
letter-spacing: 1px;
text-transform: uppercase | lowercase | capitalize;

8. COLORS & BACKGROUNDS

color: #333;

background-color: #f0f0f0;

background-image: url('image.jpg');

background-size: cover | contain;

background-position: center | top left;

background-repeat: no-repeat | repeat;

9. TRANSITIONS & ANIMATIONS

Transition Example:

```
button {  
  transition: background-color 0.3s ease;  
}  
button:hover {  
  background-color: blue;  
}
```

Keyframe Animation Example:

```
@keyframes slideIn {  
  from { transform: translateX(-100%); }  
  to { transform: translateX(0); }  
}
```

```
.element {  
  animation: slideIn 1s ease-out;  
}
```

10. MEDIA QUERIES

Make websites responsive based on screen size:

```
@media (max-width: 768px) {  
  body {  
    font-size: 14px;  
  }  
}
```

Common breakpoints:

- 480px — small devices
- 768px — tablets
- 1024px — desktops

11. COMMON SNIPPETS & BEST PRACTICES

Center a div:

```
.parent {  
  display: flex;  
  justify-content: center;  
  align-items: center;  
}
```

Reset all elements

```
* {  
  margin: 0;  
  padding: 0;  
  box-sizing: border-box;  
}
```

Text truncation

```
.ellipsis {  
  white-space: nowrap;  
  overflow: hidden;  
  text-overflow: ellipsis;  
}
```


12. CSS UNITS & FUNCTIONS

COMMON UNITS:

- PX – PIXELS (ABSOLUTE)
- EM – RELATIVE TO PARENT
- REM – RELATIVE TO ROOT
- % – PERCENTAGE
- VH/VW – VIEWPORT HEIGHT/WIDTH

Functions

```
width: calc(100% - 50px);  
font-size: clamp(1rem, 2vw, 2rem);
```

13.



QUICK CHEAT TABLE

Property	Example	Description
color	color: red;	Text color
padding	padding: 10px;	Inner spacing
margin	margin: 20px;	Outer spacing
display	display: flex;	Layout type
position	position: absolute;	Positioning method
text-align	text-align: center;	Text alignment
font-size	font-size: 18px;	Size of text
background-color	background-color: #fff;	Element background color

Thank
you